BKCB6

Landmarks/Land Use 05/23

May 23, 2024 / 6:30 PM / Van Alen / Zoom

COMMITTEE ATTENDEES- Quorum Met

David Briggs- Zoom

Peter Fleming- Zoom

Bob Levine- Zoom

Pauline Blake- Zoom

Jerry Armer

Kathleen Addison

Allison Reeves

Madelaine Murphy

Kara Gurl

Daniel Kummer

Nick Molinari

AGENDA

Landmarks

1. 345 Hoyt St- CofA
    a. David Briggs recusing himself
    b. Presenter: Architect Arturo Bárcenas of NV Architecture, obo owners
    c. Townhouse used to have two storefronts and garage in back, a possible once had bay side bulkhead, current use is all residential with garage on side deteriorating

d. Changes proposed to Hoyt St facade, Carroll St facade, garage (also on Carroll)

    i. Change to President: front door, decorative cornice, note that this is a residential entrance on a garden level (formerly commercial) but mimicking detail and scale of parlor floor entrances in area

    ii. Change to Carroll St: new windows, bay window, reconstructed garage + parapet (shown in 1940 tax photo)

    iii. Adding herringbone pavers and plantings, fence around the property (constant height with sloping)

    iv. Committee questions:

        1. Daniel asked if fencing above garage could be vertical and not horizontal as presented (architect felt horizontal was less visible from the street, Daniel and Jerry said vertical is more appropriate to the area).

        2. Jerry asked why neighbor's house was shown as changing in proposed/existing sketches, which is because LPC has approved that project and helps argue for the current proposal

        3. Bob asked about bulkhead precedents/cornices, was satisfied by photos shown

    v. Jerry made motion to approve as presented, Peter seconded, conditioned upon change in garage fencing

    vi. Motion passed unanimously with David abstaining for cause

2. 839 President St- CofA

    a. Presenter: Tom Winter of Tom Winter Architects, obo owners

    b. application to add penthouse, already have approved plans for windows

    c. Views outside of landmarked area

d. 4-family being converted to a single family

e. Proposed changes have already received LPC staff approval

3. Community Member questions/comments:

a. Daniela and Robert (live at 841 President St), claiming increased sized and visibility from photos, claims it impedes view of Manhattan and privacy from backyard

b. Liz- lives at 837 President, claims same things as Daniela

c. Daniela provided pictures and blew them up on posterboard, upon being asked by David to point to where her pictures were different from the ones in the presentation and we could not find any, and David noted private rooftops are not the criterion, just visible from public

4. Daniel made motion to disapprove as presented, Jerry seconded the motion

a. Allison, Angelica, David are against the motion

b. 0 abstentions

c. Daniel, Jerry, Bob, Pauline, Peter are for the motion

Land Use

- **City of Yes**
  - Emily Bachman from DCP joined by Katherine and Maria (transpo planner)
  - Third and final (Carbon neutrality, economic opportunity, housing), citywide text amendment to change zoning to enable a little more housing in every neighborhood
  - Committee needs to vote on whether we support the proposal
  - Severe housing shortage (1.27% vacancy rate in BK rentals), over 52% are rent burdened
  - Existing zoning tools: voluntary inclusionary housing (4th ave and 365 Bond), MIH in Gowanus rezone
  - Majority of residential zoning in CD6 is medium density
  - TOD proposal: 5000sqft lot, located on short end of block or wide street, within 0.5mile of subway, impacts most of CD6

    - ADUs: basement ADUs not allowed in coastal floodplain (shown in CD6 covering much of Red Hook and Gowanus around the canal)
    - UAP :allows buildings to add 20% more housing if it is permanently affordable or supportive housing
        - Affordability requirement of 60% AMI
        - Income averaging: replace VIH for deeper levels of affordability, no band exceeding 100% AMI
        - MIH in place would remain: Gowanus Neighborhood Plan
        - Historic district regulations and LPC procedures remain in place
        - Limited height district in Cobble Hill historic district: proposal would … (get clarification)
        - MIH Option 3 (Deeply Affordable) would be standalone option without needing to opt into 1 and 2 (currently the rule)
        - Streamline rules for 100% affordable projects
    - Remove parking mandates: parking optional for new developments throughout the city
        - Parking spaces take up space and is very expensive, obstacle to affordable housing due to price and FAR limitations
            - Does not change on street parking regulations at all, not impose new parking maximums, wouldn't automatically remove any existing parking
            - Underbuilding has been an issue due to automatic unit triggering that is proposing to be removed
    - Conversions:
        - Adaptive reuse regulations expanded, vacant office building to be converted to housing, also vacant schools/religious buildings
        - Move eligibility requirement from current 1970s construction date to 1992 to qualify for adaptive reuse
    - Landmark TDR program
- Committee Discussion
    - What is a "transit zone"? Relates to TOD
        - Red Hook was designated a "transit zone" in 2016 despite its distance from trains
        - Red Hook Coastal Resiliency talks (outside of this) have been asked to provide updated numbers

        - Bob asked about 9th St- wouldn't be affected by TOD (low density districts)
        - How does the zoning change incentivize developers to use the UAP FAR bump?
        - Tom TracauQ : does any part of the proposal that makes the subway more ADA compliant?
            - A: Zoning for Accessibility: developers can do this in TODs, elevator banks wouldn't count towards FAR (from 2020 zoning text amendment)
        - Tom Q2: And basement apartments flood outside of the shown flood zone, concerned about this (Nick concurred)
            - A: proposal would change in zoning code what is allowed to be built, but DOB and state laws need to change to eliminate those risks
    - Community Discussion
        - Amy Breedlove: "sounds like an HPD proposal" where is the city planning of services, access to fresh food, schools, and amenities?
            - Emily: comprehensive planning would be great but is outside the scope
        - Rachel: architect working to provide affordable housing, here in support of the proposal-elimination of units by her in Henry St for single family construction
            - Encourage light, air, recreation within developments, ensures housing opportunities are spread out among more places
        - Robert Gaines: Cobble Hill resident, public interest attorney, housing affordability is imperative. Lives in more affordable market rate unit and still spends 50% of income on rent. Strongly approves of the proposal, only reservation is that it doesn't go far enough, asks for the committee to approve
        - Douglas Hanau: Cobble Hill resident, sees no affordable (or other) units added in his neighborhood and is in support, his kids and their friends can't afford to move back
        - Roger: developer saying they need incentives to stay and they're the only ones who will build affordable housing but wanted us to revisit 485

Motion to approve in full: Angelica made motion, Cara seconded

- Daniel made friendly amendment to push for a more comprehensive plan, and we did approve the first two
- Nick abstaining for cause, Alison abstaining without cause
- All else in favor!

- Housing Now, Housing for Generations
    - Support to endorse: Cara made motion, Angelica seconded
    - Alison, Daniel, Pauline abstained (want to review)
    - Motion passes
- Daniel motion to adjourn